

Webcam / Camera

Every laptop has a built-in cam at the top. For PCs, you need to get one externally. The camera is useful for recording video but mostly useful when you need to video chat.

The key points to consider when buying one are:

1. **Input resolution:** Some cameras are low-resolution and cannot produce high-quality video while others can see the world in 720p or better. It is always better to get one with a higher resolution.
2. **Frame rates:** If the frame rates are low, the other party will see your video lagging. Most of the time it is not the case but drivers bundled with the camera can play evil.
3. **Mounting options:** Some cameras can be made to sit atop a flat surface, while others can be clipped onto the edge of a monitor. This factor can limit your placement options significantly.
4. **Compatibility:** You might be planning to use Linux with your system while the camera does not get detected by the OS.



Webcams are essential for livestreaming

A similar situation might come up with Windows too where the driver software might not be compatible with your version of Windows. Always double check.

You may not need a camera most of the times. If video chatting is not something you need to do frequently from your desk, you can do without one.

Wi-Fi dongle / adapter

PCs are supposed to be sitting at one place and you would normally get an Ethernet cable from your router to plug it to the network. Although, you might need a Wi-Fi dongle if you want one less cable to manage. The need of this one is also subjective. If you connect to the Internet via an Ethernet cable coming out of a router that can double up as a Wi-Fi Access Point. However, if you need to use the Internet via your phone, we would recommend a Wi-Fi Dongle over USB tethering.